

Counsel Shortlist — Retail / E-Commerce Firms for the Global Launch

⚠ **NOT LEGAL ADVICE AND NOT AN ENDORSEMENT.** A research shortlist of U.S. law firms with retail/e-commerce, IP/trademark, data-privacy, international, and advertising/promotions capability, to help select counsel for the global launch. Ordered by **proximity to Grand Rapids, MI** (the owner's location). Completeness is not guaranteed — these are firms with a genuinely relevant practice mix, not every firm online. Compiled from public firm materials, 2026-09-13. Companion to GLOBAL-LAUNCH-LEGAL-STRATEGY-BRIEF.md.

Practice-fit tags: [R] Retail/E-commerce · [IP] IP/Trademark (Madrid) · [P] Privacy (GDPR) · [Intl] International/global network · [A] Advertising/Promotions (sweepstakes — the prize competition).

Tier 1 — Grand Rapids offices (closest)

#	Firm	Base	Fit	Why it fits
1	Warner Norcross + Judd	Grand Rapids HQ	IP · P · Intl	Strongest local all-rounder; WTR 1000 trademark, cybersecurity/privacy, IT transactions; TerraLex global network (quarterbacks foreign counsel)
2	Varnum LLP	Grand Rapids HQ	P · IP · Intl	Full-service business; dedicated data-privacy & cybersecurity; IP
3	Miller Johnson	Grand Rapids	IP · P · Intl	Explicit International practice; IP counseling/transactions; privacy & tech transactions
4	Barnes & Thornburg	GR office (national)	R · IP · Intl	National scale with a GR office; retail/consumer, compliance, product liability
5	Dickinson Wright	GR office (Detroit/natl)	IP · Intl	WTR 1000 IP; technology transactions; cross-border (incl. Canada)
6	Mika Meyers	Grand Rapids	IP	Technology & IP within a respected GR business firm; closer-to-home mid-size
7	Foster Swift / Clark Hill	GR offices	IP · P	Full-service business + IP alternates (Lansing-/Detroit-based, GR offices)
8	Oppenhuizen / Willis Law	Grand Rapids	IP	GR IP boutiques (patent/trademark, IP litigation); IP-specific, not the full global build

Tier 2 — Elsewhere in Michigan (Detroit metro, ~2.5 hrs east)

#	Firm	Base	Fit	Why it fits
9	Honigman LLP	Detroit (+GR)	IP · P · Intl	Michigan's largest firm; corporate, commercial transactions, IP
10	Dykema Gossett	Detroit (national)	R · IP · Intl	Corporate/retail/consumer + IP
11	Butzel · Bodman · Miller Canfield · Howard & Howard · Kerr Russell	Detroit metro	IP	Established MI business firms with IP/corporate capability — alternates to vet

Tier 3 — National firms built for the global build (no MI office; engage remotely)

#	Firm	Fit	Why it fits
12	Perkins Coie	R · A · P	Retail & Consumer Products group + Advertising/Marketing/Promotions (sweepstakes) + privacy — best single-firm fit
13	Baker McKenzie	R · A · P · Intl	Global leader for multi-country launches; publishes cross-jurisdiction promotions/advertising guides — best if "maximum countries" is the goal
14	DLA Piper	R · A · Intl	Global; advertising/marketing/promotions + IP + privacy
15	White & Case	R · Intl	Dedicated E-Commerce offering in a Consumer & Retail group
16	Pillsbury Winthrop	R · P	Named Retail, Ecommerce & Consumer Brands sector practice
17	Loeb & Loeb · Venable · Kelley Drye · Davis & Gilbert · Frankfurt Kurnit	A · P	Advertising/promotions/privacy specialists — focused review of the prize competition + marketing claims

Screening questions to ask each firm (pre-filled from the global-launch brief)

- International reach:** Do you have an international network, or can you quarterback local counsel in my target markets? (The decisive question — a "yes" is what makes a single lead firm workable for a global launch. Warner Norcross + Judd's TerraLex membership is a concrete yes.)
- Closed-loop firewall:** Can you confirm my non-cashable, closed-loop store-credit model keeps me outside money-transmitter / e-money licensing per target market, and flag any market where stored-value rules attach?
- Prize competition:** Can you assess the skill-based + free-entry (AMOE) prize competition for sweepstakes/lottery/gambling exposure per jurisdiction? (Highest-variance item.)
- IP filings:** Can you handle the trademark via the **Madrid Protocol** and the patent via the **PCT** (provisional already drafted)?
- Privacy:** Can you set up GDPR/UK-GDPR compliance, the EU/UK Article 27 representatives, and a lawful international-transfer mechanism?
- Tax coordination:** Can you coordinate with an international-tax advisor on VAT OSS and marketplace-facilitator/nexus? (Tax is a CPA-network job run in parallel.)
- Per-market triage:** Will you sort my target-market list into *clear with baseline* / *needs local review* / *geo-restrict*, and sign off on a phased rollout?
- Retail/e-commerce + AI:** Do you have a retail/e-commerce practice, and are you comfortable with AI-generated advertising

content and AI-content disclosure obligations?

Suggested structure (per the global brief): a Grand Rapids lead firm — Warner Norcross + Judd or Varnum are the strongest local fits — as the hub, with a national retail specialist (**Perkins Coie** or **Baker McKenzie**) engaged for the international promotions/privacy layer, plus an international-tax advisor alongside.

Not legal advice; not an endorsement or referral. Verify each firm's current capabilities, conflicts, and fees directly. Related: GLOBAL-LAUNCH-LEGAL-STRATEGY-BRIEF.md, FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md.